

THEY'RE STILL THERE

Game Jam Proposal | Team The Three Monkeys

Team	The Three Monkeys
Member	Karthikeya Aduri Discord: theadotk Email: karthikeya.aduri@research.iiit.ac.in Indieconnect: kdota
Member	Shantanu Mande Discord: willynotreally_ Email: shantanu.mande@research.iiit.ac.in Indieconnect: willynotreally1
Member	Hrigved Naidu Discord: rig.vedaa Email: hrigved.mande@research.iiit.ac.in Indieconnect: rigveda
Engine / Platform	Godot Browser

1. Concept

They're Still There is a short comic and manga style survival game set inside a school during a complete blackout. The player must navigate the school and find a way out while managing a flashlight with limited battery. Monsters follow and approach the player whenever they are outside the flashlight's illumination. The player cannot fight them. Survival depends entirely on movement, route planning, observation and careful use of light. The game uses a situational comic panel camera. Normal navigation establishes the school space, while encounters, discoveries, monster appearances and other key moments can lock the camera into manga like compositions.

2. Core Gameplay Loop

Enter the school → learn the layout → navigate through the blackout → manage flashlight battery → keep monsters within the light when necessary → avoid threats and choose routes → experience situational comic panel moments → reach the exit. The flashlight is simultaneously the player's main defensive tool and a limited resource. Keeping a monster illuminated prevents it from freely approaching, but the player cannot rely on unlimited light. This creates a constant trade off between safety, exploration and progress.

3. Game Flow

Opening: The player enters the school and the lights go out. The opening teaches movement, flashlight use, battery limits and the basic monster rule without requiring combat.

Exploration: The player begins learning the school's layout, using visual landmarks and remembered routes to move toward the exit. Darkness makes familiar spaces uncertain and increases the importance of navigation.

Escalation: Monster encounters become more demanding as the player progresses. The player must decide when to illuminate a threat, when to move, and which route is safest. Situational camera locks can turn major encounters into comic panel compositions.

Escape: The final section leads the player toward the school exit. The experience resolves as a compact, complete survival loop designed for approximately 10 to 15 minutes of first playthrough gameplay.

4. Theme Justification

COMIC

The game's visual identity is based on comic and manga presentation. Situational camera locks create panel like compositions during important moments, with framing used for monster reveals, discoveries, danger and transitions. The presentation can incorporate ink like silhouettes, strong contrast, speed lines and exaggerated framing where appropriate. Comic language is therefore part of the gameplay presentation rather than simply a menu or cutscene style.

TWIST

The game's central twist comes from both its monsters and the school itself. The monsters do not simply hide in darkness. Darkness allows them to move toward the player, making light a temporary way of controlling the threat. As the player progresses, the school also begins to feel increasingly warped and distorted. The overall directions and navigational logic remain understandable, but familiar spaces can subtly change. Corridors may feel longer, rooms may appear different, and landmarks may seem displaced.

This means the player can learn the school's layout and build a mental map, but that map is gradually challenged. The game does not become a random maze. Instead, the player is forced to question their memory of a space they thought they understood. Situational comic panel framing can reinforce these changes by presenting familiar locations from unsettling or exaggerated perspectives.

LIGHT

Light is the central mechanic, resource and source of safety. The flashlight determines when monsters can approach and its limited battery forces the player to make decisions. Light is therefore directly embedded into the rules of survival rather than being only an aesthetic element.

5. Player and Monster Interaction

Monsters pursue the player while outside the flashlight's illumination. When illuminated, they are temporarily controlled by the light and cannot freely advance. The player must use positioning and movement to survive rather than attack. If a monster reaches the player, the player is eaten and the attempt ends or restarts from the appropriate checkpoint.

6. Narrative and Presentation Direction

The player enters what initially appears to be an ordinary school and gradually becomes increasingly uncomfortable with the spaces around them. The monsters are presented as twisted figures associated with the school environment. Rather than relying on long cutscenes, the game communicates its atmosphere through environmental exploration, encounters, comic panel framing and changes in how familiar spaces are presented.

7. Scope and Jam Feasibility

The project is intentionally built around a compact set of systems: player movement, flashlight and battery management, monster pursuit, collision and death, school navigation, situational camera states and a short progression toward the exit. There is no combat, large inventory or complex progression system. This keeps development focused on polishing the central mechanic and presentation within the 100 hour event.

The game will be developed in Godot for browser delivery. All core game code, mechanics and architecture will be created during the jam in accordance with the fresh codebase rules. Permitted third party assets will be documented with sources and licenses, and any AI assisted work will be fully disclosed as required by the event.

8. Intended Final Experience

The intended experience is a focused 10 to 15 minute survival game. The player enters the school, learns how the blackout and monsters work, learns the environment, manages a dwindling light source, survives increasingly tense encounters and ultimately escapes. The combination of light based avoidance, comic panel presentation and a warped but navigable school gives the game a clear identity while keeping the implementation achievable for a game jam.